

they do is publish printable gun components. People have used this to make working guns. They even provide a download link to the required software to do so on their very own website, alongside highlighting the case against them from the US Dept. of State. In one swift move, this has the ability to render gun control laws useless across the globe.

A mad rush to complete a product is not always good on the part of a maker. It comes with social consequences and there is an urgent need to stop and comprehend the ripples that will be generated by their product. We need to evolve our moral and ethical framework at the same speed at which our technology is progressing. It is not an option or a particular choice of path; it is an obligation of the maker community to society.

How does a maker work?

Even if we strictly look at all of this from a professional point of view, the way a maker works is not independent of society and its culture. One of the most used platforms for makers to scale their product to the larger market is crowdfunding. Organisations like Kickstarter and Indiegogo are making access to funds easier every day by letting makers showcase their idea to the online community and letting the online community contribute whatever they can. The purpose of these contributions is to make it possible for the maker to bring a product to the contributor, which requires scaling. Even though a direct motivation behind such contributions is a reward, it is definitely another way that a community contributes to innovation. Crowdfunding has seen many projects not only launch commercially, but also become mainstream successes, like the Pebble Smartwatch.

Apart from Crowdfunding, crowdsourcing is also a method by which a maker incorporates the power of a community into their project. The word is a portmanteau of 'crowd' and 'outsourcing' and means exactly what that combination implies. Instead of allocating the work to a consultancy or an industrial firm, work is shared with the community and is fulfilled by the community as a whole. What can be a better example of crowdsourcing than Wikipedia? Based on the ideas of free and open information, accessible and editable by everyone, it is a fine example of how a community working together can create something so massively useful to the community itself, just because we possess a diverse knowledge base that can only help when shared. Apart from the usefulness, crowdsourcing often results in realistic results that would not be possible with statistical assumptions and partial analysis. Take the ESP game implemented by Google as the Google Image